

Men's Ballon d'Or

France Football created the Ballon d'Or in 1956. Eligibility rules changed over time: the award was initially limited to European players, opened to players of any nationality at European clubs in 1995, and became fully global in 2007. From 2010 through 2015 it was presented jointly with FIFA.

Men's Ballon d'Or winners, 1956 to present

Year	Winner	National team	Ceremony date	Story
2025	Ousmane Dembélé	France	22 September 2025	—
2024	Rodri	Spain	28 October 2024	—
2023	Lionel Messi	Argentina	30 October 2023	—
2022	Karim Benzema	France	17 October 2022	—
2021	Lionel Messi	Argentina	29 November 2021	—
2020	Not awarded	—	—	▶ Tap to read the story The 2020 Ballon d'Or was the only edition since the award's creation in 1956 not to be presented.

Year	Winner	National team	Ceremony date	Story
<u>2019</u>	<u>Lionel Messi</u>	Argentina	2 December 2019	—
<u>2018</u>	<u>Luka Modrić</u>	Croatia	3 December 2018	▶  Tap to read the story Luka Modrić became the only Croatian winner of the Ballon d'Or in 2018.
<u>2017</u>	<u>Cristiano Ronaldo</u>	Portugal	7 December 2017	—
<u>2016</u>	<u>Cristiano Ronaldo</u>	Portugal	12 December 2016	—
<u>2015</u>	<u>Lionel Messi</u>	Argentina	11 January 2016	—
<u>2014</u>	<u>Cristiano Ronaldo</u>	Portugal	12 January 2015	—
<u>2013</u>	<u>Cristiano Ronaldo</u>	Portugal	13 January 2014	—
<u>2012</u>	<u>Lionel Messi</u>	Argentina	7 January 2013	—
<u>2011</u>	<u>Lionel Messi</u>	Argentina	9 January 2012	—
<u>2010</u>	<u>Lionel Messi</u>	Argentina	10 January 2011	—
<u>2009</u>	<u>Lionel Messi</u>	Argentina	1 December 2009	▶  Tap to read the story Lionel Messi won the first of his eight Ballon d'Or titles in 2009, more than any other player in the award's history.

Year	Winner	National team	Ceremony date	Story
<u>2008</u>	<u>Cristiano Ronaldo</u>	Portugal	2 December 2008	—
<u>2007</u>	<u>Kaká</u>	Brazil	2 December 2007	▶  Tap to read the story Kaká won the 2007 Ballon d'Or, the first year the award opened to any nationality at any club worldwide.
<u>2006</u>	<u>Fabio Cannavaro</u>	Italy	27 November 2006	—
<u>2005</u>	<u>Ronaldinho</u>	Brazil	28 November 2005	—
<u>2004</u>	<u>Andriy Shevchenko</u>	Ukraine	13 December 2004	—
<u>2003</u>	<u>Pavel Nedvěd</u>	Czech Republic	22 December 2003	—
<u>2002</u>	<u>Ronaldo</u>	Brazil	12 December 2002	—
<u>2001</u>	<u>Michael Owen</u>	England	18 December 2001	—
<u>2000</u>	<u>Luís Figo</u>	Portugal	19 December 2000	—
<u>1999</u>	<u>Rivaldo</u>	Brazil	21 December 1999	—
<u>1998</u>	<u>Zinedine Zidane</u>	France	22 December 1998	—

Year	Winner	National team	Ceremony date	Story
<u>1997</u>	<u>Ronaldo</u>	Brazil	23 December 1997	► 📖 Tap to read the story Ronaldo (Brazil) is the Ballon d'Or's youngest-ever winner, aged 21 when he won in 1997.
<u>1996</u>	<u>Matthias Sammer</u>	Germany	24 December 1996	—
<u>1995</u>	<u>George Weah</u>	Liberia	26 December 1995	► 📖 Tap to read the story George Weah became the first African player to win the Ballon d'Or in 1995.
<u>1994</u>	<u>Hristo Stoichkov</u>	Bulgaria	20 December 1994	—
<u>1993</u>	<u>Roberto Baggio</u>	Italy	28 December 1993	—
<u>1992</u>	<u>Marco van Basten</u>	Netherlands	22 December 1992	—
<u>1991</u>	<u>Jean-Pierre Papin</u>	France	24 December 1991	—
<u>1990</u>	<u>Lothar Matthäus</u>	West Germany	25 December 1990	—
<u>1989</u>	<u>Marco van Basten</u>	Netherlands	26 December 1989	—
<u>1988</u>	<u>Marco van Basten</u>	Netherlands	27 December 1988	—
<u>1987</u>	<u>Ruud Gullit</u>	Netherlands	29 December 1987	—

Year	Winner	National team	Ceremony date	Story
<u>1986</u>	<u>Igor Belanov</u>	Soviet Union	30 December 1986	—
<u>1985</u>	<u>Michel Platini</u>	France	24 December 1985	—
<u>1984</u>	<u>Michel Platini</u>	France	25 December 1984	—
<u>1983</u>	<u>Michel Platini</u>	France	27 December 1983	—
<u>1982</u>	<u>Paolo Rossi</u>	Italy	28 December 1982	—
<u>1981</u>	<u>Karl-Heinz Rummenigge</u>	West Germany	29 December 1981	—
<u>1980</u>	<u>Karl-Heinz Rummenigge</u>	West Germany	30 December 1980	—
<u>1979</u>	<u>Kevin Keegan</u>	England	25 December 1979	—
<u>1978</u>	<u>Kevin Keegan</u>	England	27 December 1978	—
<u>1977</u>	<u>Allan Simonsen</u>	Denmark	27 December 1977	—
<u>1976</u>	<u>Franz Beckenbauer</u>	West Germany	28 December 1976	—
<u>1975</u>	<u>Oleg Blokhin</u>	Soviet Union	30 December 1975	—
<u>1974</u>	<u>Johan Cruyff</u>	Netherlands	31 December 1974	—
<u>1973</u>	<u>Johan Cruyff</u>	Netherlands	25 December 1973	—
<u>1972</u>	<u>Franz Beckenbauer</u>	West Germany	26 December 1972	—

Year	Winner	National team	Ceremony date	Story
<u>1971</u>	<u>Johan Cruyff</u>	Netherlands	28 December 1971	—
<u>1970</u>	<u>Gerd Müller</u>	West Germany	29 December 1970	—
<u>1969</u>	<u>Gianni Rivera</u>	Italy	23 December 1969	—
<u>1968</u>	<u>George Best</u>	Northern Ireland	24 December 1968	—
<u>1967</u>	<u>Flórián Albert</u>	Hungary	26 December 1967	—
<u>1966</u>	<u>Bobby Charlton</u>	England	27 December 1966	—
<u>1965</u>	<u>Eusébio</u>	Portugal	28 December 1965	—
<u>1964</u>	<u>Denis Law</u>	Scotland	22 December 1964	—
<u>1963</u>	<u>Lev Yashin</u>	Soviet Union	17 December 1963	—
<u>1962</u>	<u>Josef Masopust</u>	Czechoslovakia	18 December 1962	—
<u>1961</u>	<u>Omar Sívori</u>	Italy	12 December 1961	—
<u>1960</u>	<u>Luis Suárez</u>	Spain	13 December 1960	—
<u>1959</u>	<u>Alfredo Di Stéfano</u>	Spain	15 December 1959	—
<u>1958</u>	<u>Raymond Kopa</u>	France	16 December 1958	—
<u>1957</u>	<u>Alfredo Di Stéfano</u>	Spain	17 December 1957	—

Year	Winner	National team	Ceremony date	Story
<u>1956</u>	<u>Stanley Matthews</u>	England	18 December 1956	▶ 📖 Tap to read the story Stanley Matthews won the first-ever Ballon d'Or in 1956.

Champions by titles

Generated automatically from the edition table above. Totals group a nation with its sporting predecessor only where the source content does (Germany includes West Germany); every other name is counted as written.

Lionel Messi 2009, 2010, 2011, 2012, 2015, 2019, 2021, 2023	8
Cristiano Ronaldo 2008, 2013, 2014, 2016, 2017	5
Johan Cruyff 1971, 1973, 1974	3
Michel Platini 1983, 1984, 1985	3
Marco van Basten 1988, 1989, 1992	3

Alfredo Di Stéfano 1957, 1959	2
Franz Beckenbauer 1972, 1976	2
Kevin Keegan 1978, 1979	2
Karl-Heinz Rummenigge 1980, 1981	2
Ronaldo 1997, 2002	2
Stanley Matthews 1956	1
Raymond Kopa 1958	1
Luis Suárez 1960	1
Omar Sívori 1961	1

Josef Masopust  1962	1
Lev Yashin  1963	1
Denis Law  1964	1
Eusébio  1965	1
Bobby Charlton  1966	1
Flórián Albert  1967	1
George Best  1968	1
Gianni Rivera  1969	1
Gerd Müller  1970	1

Oleg Blokhin  1975	1
Allan Simonsen  1977	1
Paolo Rossi  1982	1
Igor Belanov  1986	1
Ruud Gullit  1987	1
Lothar Matthäus  1990	1
Jean-Pierre Papin  1991	1
Roberto Baggio  1993	1
Hristo Stoichkov  1994	1

George Weah  1995	1
Matthias Sammer  1996	1
Zinedine Zidane  1998	1
Rivaldo  1999	1
Luís Figo  2000	1
Michael Owen  2001	1
Pavel Nedvěd  2003	1
Andriy Shevchenko  2004	1
Ronaldinho  2005	1

Fabio Cannavaro	1
2006	
Kaká	1
2007	
Luka Modrić	1
2018	
Karim Benzema	1
2022	
Rodri	1
2024	
Ousmane Dembélé	1
2025	

 How it works

- The Ballon d'Or honors the best individual men's player of the year - it is not a team competition or a national-team trophy.
- A panel of football journalists, one from each eligible country, ranks their top players; the votes are combined into one final ranking.
- Eligibility has widened over time: Europe-only at first, then any nationality at a European club from 1995, then fully global since 2007 (see the introduction above).
- The winner is announced at a ceremony organized by France Football magazine - held at year's end through 2021, then moved to September/October from 2022 onward (see the Ceremony date column above).

 Kopa Trophy winners

- France Football has presented the Kopa Trophy, a companion "best young player" award for the world's best player aged 21 or under, alongside the Ballon d'Or every year since 2018; it was not awarded in 2020, the one year the Ballon d'Or itself was cancelled.
- **2018:** Kylian Mbappé (France) - the trophy's first winner.
- **2019:** Matthijs de Ligt (Netherlands).
- **2020:** Not awarded.
- **2021:** Pedri (Spain).
- **2022:** Gavi (Spain).
- **2023:** Jude Bellingham (England).
- **2024:** Lamine Yamal (Spain).
- **2025:** Lamine Yamal (Spain) - the first player to win the Kopa Trophy twice.



Yashin Trophy winners

- France Football has also presented the Yashin Trophy, a companion "best goalkeeper" award named after Lev Yashin, alongside the Ballon d'Or every year since 2019; it was not awarded in 2020, the one year the Ballon d'Or itself was cancelled.
- **2019:** Alisson (Brazil) - the trophy's first winner.
- **2020:** Not awarded.
- **2021:** Gianluigi Donnarumma (Italy).
- **2022:** Thibaut Courtois (Belgium).
- **2023:** Emiliano Martínez (Argentina).
- **2024:** Emiliano Martínez (Argentina) - the first goalkeeper to win the Yashin Trophy in consecutive years.
- **2025:** Gianluigi Donnarumma (Italy) - his second Yashin Trophy, making him the second goalkeeper (after Martínez) to win it more than once.



Gerd Müller Trophy winners

- France Football has also presented an award for the year's top goalscorer (club and country combined) alongside the Ballon d'Or every year since 2021; it was first awarded under the name "Striker of the Year" and renamed the Gerd Müller Trophy from 2022 onward,

honoring the West Germany and Bayern Munich forward (1970 Ballon d'Or winner, see the Winners table above) after his death in August 2021 - unlike the Kopa and Yashin trophies above, it has no gap year, since it started the year after the 2020 cancellation rather than before it.

- **2021:** Robert Lewandowski (Poland) - the award's first winner, under its original name.
- **2022:** Robert Lewandowski (Poland) - the first winner under the renamed Gerd Müller Trophy, and the trophy's first repeat winner.
- **2023:** Erling Haaland (Norway).
- **2024:** Harry Kane (England) and Kylian Mbappé (France) - the trophy's first tie, both credited as joint winners on the same goal tally.
- **2025:** Viktor Gyökeres (Sweden).



Johan Cruyff Trophy winners

- France Football has also presented the Johan Cruyff Trophy, a companion "best men's coach" award named after the Netherlands great (three-time Ballon d'Or winner, see the Winners table above), alongside the Ballon d'Or every year since 2024 - the newest of the three companion trophies on this page, with no gap year since it started after the Kopa/Yashin/Gerd Müller trophies had already established the pattern.
- **2024:** Carlo Ancelotti (Real Madrid) - the trophy's first winner, honored for Real Madrid's La Liga and UEFA Champions League double.
- **2025:** Luis Enrique (Paris Saint-Germain) - honored for PSG's Ligue 1, Coupe de France and first-ever UEFA Champions League title.



Socrates Award winners

- France Football has also presented the Sócrates Award, a companion humanitarian award named after Brazilian great Sócrates and presented in partnership with Peace and Sport, alongside the Ballon d'Or every year since 2022 - unlike the Kopa, Yashin, Gerd Müller and Johan Cruyff trophies above, it is not restricted to men's football performance: it has gone to a female footballer and, in 2025, to a charitable foundation rather than an individual player.
- **2022:** Sadio Mané (Senegal) - the award's first winner, honored for funding a hospital, a secondary school and other infrastructure in his home village of Bambali.
- **2023:** Vinícius Júnior (Brazil) - honored for Instituto Vini Jr.'s work against racism and educational inequality in Brazil.
- **2024:** Jennifer Hermoso (Spain) - the award's first female recipient, honored for her advocacy against sexual abuse and harassment in sport.

- **2025:** Xana Foundation - founded by Johan Cruyff Trophy winner Luis Enrique (see above) and his wife Elena Cullell in memory of their daughter Xana, who died in 2019; the award's first winner that is not an individual footballer.

Memorable moments

- Stanley Matthews won the first-ever Ballon d'Or in 1956.
- George Weah became the first African player to win the Ballon d'Or in 1995.
- Kaká won the 2007 Ballon d'Or, the first year the award opened to any nationality at any club worldwide.
- Lionel Messi won the first of his eight Ballon d'Or titles in 2009, more than any other player in the award's history.
- Luka Modrić became the only Croatian winner of the Ballon d'Or in 2018.
- The 2020 Ballon d'Or was the only edition since the award's creation in 1956 not to be presented.
- Stanley Matthews remains the Ballon d'Or's oldest-ever winner, aged 41 when he claimed the inaugural award in 1956 - a record that has stood for seven decades.
- Ronaldo (Brazil) is the Ballon d'Or's youngest-ever winner, aged 21 when he won in 1997.

Notes

- Lev Yashin remains the only goalkeeper to win the men's award.
- George Weah became the first African winner in 1995.
- Luka Modrić won in 2018.
- The 2020 award was cancelled.
- Ousmane Dembélé won the 2025 award.

References & review

Status: verified

Last reviewed: 2 October 2026

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Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.